



DoView Tool D6 - Good Indicator Checklist.

Indicators differ in their quality. Below are the features of a good indicator.

1. Is it **RELEVANT**? Is there a box within the relevant DoView strategy/outcomes diagram that the indicator can sit next to?
2. Is it **MEASURABLE**? Is it feasible to do what's needed to actually measure it?
3. Is it **AFFORDABLE**? How much will it actually cost to measure the indicator (including the cost of staff being distracted from their normal work by having to collect indicator data)? Can the indicator information be collected as part of other data collection efforts (e.g. an existing survey)? Can some other party, which also has an interest in the indicator, help pay for collecting it?
4. Is it **MANIPULABLE**? Can people whose work the indicator measures 'game' the indicator so it will seem like they are doing a better job? Can the measurement methodology be made more robust (e.g. moving away from self-report)? Can a third party be involved in measuring the indicator to verify that it is not being manipulated?
5. Is it **CONTROLLABLE**? Is it substantially influenced by the organization, agency, provider, policy or initiative so that when we measure it, we will automatically know it made it happen?
6. Will it be used as an **ACCOUNTABILITY** for the organization or initiative? If so, have you decided on the type of contracting or delegation you will use from the Four Types of Contracting for Outcomes or Outputs Tool (E3)? If a direct accountability (e.g. Key Performance Indicator, KPI) for the initiative, you can put an @ next to it in the DoView strategy/outcomes diagram to show that this is the case.
7. Which aspect of **QUANTITY**, **QUALITY**, or **TIMELINESS** does the indicator measure? Do you already have, or can you find, other indicators that measure the other two aspects?
8. Is a **TARGET** (a desired level) going to be set on the indicator? If so, use the Good Target Checklist (D6) to ensure you are setting an appropriate target.